Walker Buehler

RHP · SD · 2026 · 2,615 pitches

Family 4+: Mid-High slot, rides over



4+ | 45° Slot | 90% Efficiency | +5° Tilt | 23 BU Spin

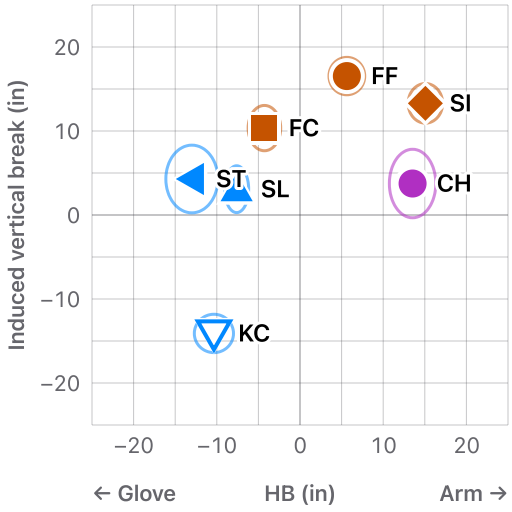


12:45

Mid-High slot, rides over Reference: Four-seam

Mid-high slot (46°) with a four-seam that rides over the slot (+5°), spun with typical efficiency (90% efficient), with low spin for its velocity (23 BU).

Arsenal Movement



Averages with one-standard-deviation ovals. Drawn from behind the pitcher: arm side is to the right.

Top Recommendations

- ● Four-seam: Ceiling 97, now 86 (gap +11). The best reachable shape is 19.0 in IVB and 5.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 16th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: High (25 comps).
- ● Slider: little room left from the current setup (Ceiling 107, now 107). Confidence: High (15 comps).
- ◐ Sinker: Ceiling 110, now 97 (gap +13). The best reachable shape is 13.0 in IVB and 18.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 50th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: Medium (8 comps).

Top Five Comps

Davis Daniel (2023)	4+ | 45/90/+5/23	98
Elieser Hernández (2021)	4+ | 45/90/+5/23	96
Logan Allen (2023)	4+ | 45/90/+5/24	95
Luis Patiño (2022)	4+ | 45/90/+5/24	94
Valente Bellozo (2024)	4 | 45/90/+5/23	94

Every Pitch: Today and Potential

Pitch	Usage	Velo	Spin	IVB	HB	Stuff+	Ceiling	Gap	Main Lever	Conf.
Cutter	24%	90.4	2370	10.3	−4.3	108	112	+5	Grip / Seam Orientation	◐
Four-seam	20%	94.0	2180	16.5	5.6	86	97	+11	Grip / Seam Orientation	●
Sinker	20%	94.2	2094	13.3	15.1	97	110	+13	Grip / Seam Orientation	◐
Slider	11%	87.1	2464	3.1	−7.6	107	107	0	Hand Position at Release	●
Changeup	9%	89.3	1226	3.7	13.5	99	110	+11	Spin Rate on This Pitch	◐
Knuckle curve	8%	78.3	2469	−14.1	−10.3	97	—	—	—	○
Sweeper	7%	82.5	2657	4.3	−13.0	109	113	+4	Grip / Seam Orientation	○

Velocity in mph, spin in rpm, movement in inches (IVB: induced vertical break; HB: horizontal break from behind the pitcher, arm side positive).

Confidence and Data Notes

Stuff+ is Spin ID's own model, not FanGraphs Stuff+. 100 is the 2021–2024 average pitch. Ceiling: what this pitcher's comps do with each pitch, at this pitcher's own velocity and release; Gap is Ceiling minus today; the lever is the change that adds the most. Fastballs keep their natural spin.

Confidence (● High, ◐ Medium, ○ Low) is how much real MLB data sits behind each estimate. Estimates, not promises.

Validity test T5 passed: Stuff+ in 2025 lined up with 2026 results at r = 0.21, better than velocity alone (0.09) and 2025 results (0.09), over 1,247 pitches.

Tested (T4, 2025 to 2026): bigger gaps came with only slightly bigger next-season Stuff+ gains (partial r 0.07; the range includes zero), so treat a gap as a direction to explore, not a forecast.

2026 season: 2,589 pitches with a pitch type; the Spin ID comes from 523 four-seams. Comps are the nearest Spin IDs (slot, efficiency, tilt offset, spin) among MLB pitcher-seasons 2021–2026.